BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

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Price Target Change


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Korea Internet

Naver Corporation

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

035420.KS **240,000 KRW** (330,000 *OLD*)

Naver: PT cut to 240K… From anchor client to ROI

Naver is searching for its place in the AI trade. Korea, like global markets, is increasingly trading as AI versus anti-AI, yet neither of Korea's two Internet giants, Naver and Kakao, has found a home on either side of the trade. Naver's anchor-client contract could establish the company as Korea's "NeoCloud" stock, but the catalyst continues to slip. The debate is now shifting beyond whether Naver can secure an anchor client to whether NeoCloud can generate attractive returns. Investors are focused on the economics: revenue per GW, the balance between leased and self-built capacity across the 1GW rollout, potential GPU carve-outs in Phase 2 and their margin implications, and ultimately the scale of Naver's total CapEx commitment under this new business model… and here's our thought.

200MW Phase 1: Taking longer, but pricing could improve. Naver appears to be broadening its customer base rather than relying on a single anchor tenant for Phase 1, pointing to a different commercialization path than initially communicated. The key off-taker agreement for the initial 200MW is taking longer to close as pricing negotiations continue. With compute pricing increase in recent months, we hope a longer negotiation window could support better pricing and project economics versus the initial c.US$15bn/GW target. We've modelled the first three years of Naver Neocloud blended revenue based on Naver's initial targets, with potential upside contingent on final contract terms.

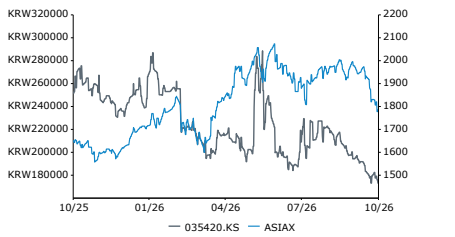
Beyond Phase 1: The bigger question is funding the next build-out. NeoCloud's long-term opportunity depends not only on securing Phase 1 off-takers, but also on successfully funding and executing Phases 2 and 3. This makes the Dunamu transaction increasingly important. With regulatory approval now delayed by c. nine months, from the initial June 2026 timeline to March 2027, we believe closing the transaction would strengthen Naver's balance sheet and enhance funding flexibility for the next stage of NeoCloud expansion.

Close Date	23 Oct 2026
035420.KS Close Price (KRW)	173,600
Price Target (KRW)	240,000
Upside/(Downside)	38%
52-Week Range	308,500/171,100
ASIAX	1,786.55
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	1.5%
Market Cap (KRW) (B)	26,406.10
EV (KRW) (B)	24,104.44

Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	(28.7)	(10.8)	(19.3)	(29.0)
ASIAX (%)	9.2	(9.7)	(2.8)	9.8
Relative (%)	(37.9)	(1.2)	(16.4)	(38.7)

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Investment Implications

We maintain **Outperform** on **Naver**. We cut our PT to KRW240K from KRW330K on 3-21% lower 2026-27 EPS. Our DCF now reflects the heavier CapEx burden from Phases 2 and 3, with the new PT implying 18x, down from 20x. We expect a weak Q3 to weigh on Naver shares, with our operating profit estimate of KRW444bn (consensus at KRW509bn), reflecting elevated marketing spend and AI investments.

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
035420.KS (KRW)	13,065	**12,209**	**12,443**
OLD	--	13,258	15,714

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
Net Earnings (M)	1,953*	1,920*	1,957*	0.1%
Operating Earnings (M)	2,208*	2,008*	2,247*	0.9%
Revenues (M)	12,035*	13,474*	16,360*	16.6%

Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
Adjusted P/E (x)	13.3	14.2	14.0
EV/EBIT (x)	10.9	12.0	10.7
EV/Sales (x)	2.0	1.8	1.5

*Values shown in billions;Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our Global Research Disclosure Website.

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DETAILS

EXHIBIT 1: **Our NeoCloud model incorporates the full Phase 1-3 rollout. The most important assumption is blended annualized revenue per GW. Changes to management's revenue-per-GW guidance could have a meaningful impact on project economics, ROI, and ultimately our valuation of Naver.**

	2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031	2032
ENTERPRISE (CLOUD)								
Enterprise revenue (KRW bn)	**587.7**	**665.6**	**1,832.8**	**6,561.1**	**12,560.5**	**19,971.3**	**24,344.8**	**28,656.0**
Growth YoY	4.3%	13.2%	175.4%	258.0%	91.4%	59.0%	21.9%	17.7%
Growth QoQ								
Enterprise revenue (excl. AI factory model) (KRW bn)	**587.7**	**665.6**	**698.9**	**733.8**	**770.5**	**809.0**	**849.5**	**891.9**
Growth YoY	4.3%	13.2%	5.0%	5.0%	5.0%	5.0%	5.0%	5.0%
Growth QoQ								
AI factory (KRW bn)			**1,134.0**	**5,827.3**	**11,790.0**	**19,162.3**	**23,495.4**	**27,764.0**
Growth YoY				413.9%	102.3%	62.5%	22.6%	18.2%
Growth QoQ								
Self-built capacity								
Total (GW)			0.215	0.245	0.282	0.320	0.357	0.392
External			0.193	0.220	0.254	0.304	0.339	0.372
Assumed % external			90.0%	90.0%	90.0%	95.0%	95.0%	95.0%
Paid capacity / DC occupancy			0.0%	40.0%	70.0%	85.0%	85.0%	85.0%
Assumed capex/GW - USD								
Assumed capex/GW - KRW								
Self-built GW added			0.005	0.009	0.009	0.009	0.009	0.009
Annualised AI revenue/GW - USD bn			**2.5**	**9.8**	**15.0**	**19.3**	**19.7**	**19.9**
Annualised AI revenue/GW - KRW tn			3.8	14.6	22.1	28.7	29.2	29.5
Self-built capacity revenue			**0**	**1,280**	**3,748**	**7,082**	**8,082**	**9,019**
Rented capacity								
Annualised AI revenue/GW - USD bn			25.00	25.00	25.00	25.00	25.00	25.00
Annualised AI revenue/GW - KRW tn			37.03	37.03	37.03	37.03	37.03	37.03
Total capacity added (GW)			0.100	0.200	0.300	0.400	0.500	0.600
Rented capacity added			0.025	0.025	0.025	0.025	0.025	0.025
Paid capacity / DC occupancy			35.0%	75.0%	82.5%	90.0%	90.0%	90.0%
Blended contract revenue/GW - KRW tn			3.6	11.5	15.9	19.8	20.1	20.2
Implied AI-related products revenue			**1,134.0**	**5,827.3**	**11,790.0**	**19,162.3**	**23,495.4**	**27,764.0**
Growth YoY				413.9%	102.3%	62.5%	22.6%	18.2%
Rented capacity revenue			**1,134**	**4,548**	**8,042**	**12,080**	**15,413**	**18,745**
EBITDA margin								
Self-built capacity			80.0%	80.0%	80.0%	80.0%	80.0%	80.0%
Rented capacity			20.0%	20.0%	20.0%	20.0%	20.0%	20.0%
Non-AI revenue			25.0%	25.0%	25.0%	25.0%	25.0%	25.0%
EBITDA								
Self-built capacity			0.0	1,023.9	2,998.4	5,665.5	6,466.0	7,214.9
Rented capacity			226.8	909.5	1,608.4	2,416.1	3,082.6	3,749.1
Non-AI revenue			174.7	183.5	192.6	202.3	212.4	223.0
Cloud-only EBITDA			**402**	**2,117**	**4,799**	**8,284**	**9,761**	**11,187**
% of revenue			21.9%	32.3%	38.2%	41.5%	40.1%	39.0%
Incremental margin %								
Incremental margin % - LTM								
Naver CapEx	**-1,337.3**	**-1,554.1**	**-1,800.0**	**-3,000.0**	**-3,000.0**	**-3,000.0**	**-2,800.0**	**-2,800.0**
Assumed depreciation years	5.0	6.0	6.0	6.0	6.0	6.0	6.0	6.0
Naver depreciation & amortisation cost (KRW bn)	**-621.6**	**-960.9**	**-1,147.0**	**-1,505.3**	**-2,017.8**	**-1,978.4**	**-2,231.8**	**-2,406.3**

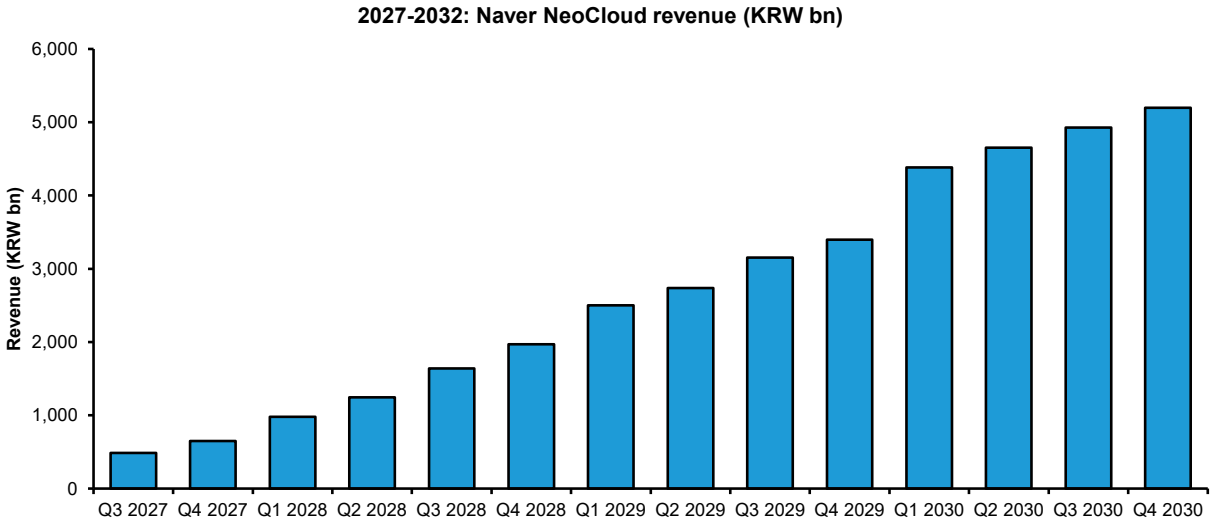
Disclaimer: Our ROI analysis remains highly sensitive to several assumptions that the company has yet to disclose in detail. Key moving pieces include revenue generated per GW of deployed capacity, the ultimate mix between leased and self-built infrastructure across the planned 1GW rollout, potential GPU carve-out arrangements in Phase 2 and their impact on economics and margins, and, most importantly, the scale of Naver's total CapEx commitment under this evolving business model. Changes in any of these assumptions could materially alter the project's returns and valuation implications. At this stage, the company has provided only limited guidance, and we believe a more robust assessment will be possible once the terms of the first major customer contract are disclosed.
Source: Bernstein estimate and analysis.

EXHIBIT 2: **Our model suggests NeoCloud reaches meaningful ROIC in Year 4. That said, project returns could vary materially depending on changes in revenue per GW, the mix of leased versus self-built capacity, GPU scope, and total CapEx requirements.**

	Year 0	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5	Year 6
P&L and cash flow projection							
Cloud-only EBIT		**(545.5)**	**811.5**	**2,981.6**	**6,025.4**	**7,249.2**	**8,500.7**
% of revenue		-29.8%	12.4%	23.7%	30.2%	29.8%	29.7%
Income tax expense		-	(162.3)	(596.3)	(1,205.1)	(1,449.8)	(1,700.1)
Effective tax rate %		-20%	-20%	-20%	-20%	-20%	-20%
NOPAT		**-546**	**649**	**2,385**	**4,820**	**5,799**	**6,801**
Maintenance capex		-359	-359	-359	-359	-359	-359
Maintenance capex		2.0%	2.0%	2.0%	2.0%	2.0%	2.0%
Unlevered free cash flow	(17,954.1)	(904.6)	290.1	2,026.2	4,461.3	5,440.2	6,441.5
Cumulative unlevered FCF	(17,954.1)	**(18,858.7)**	**(18,568.6)**	**(16,542.4)**	**(12,081.1)**	**(6,640.9)**	**(199.4)**
Invested capital	17,954.1	17,954.1	17,954.1	17,954.1	17,954.1	17,954.1	17,954.1
ROIC		**-3.0%**	**3.6%**	**13.3%**	**26.8%**	**32.3%**	**37.9%**

Disclaimer: Our ROI analysis remains highly sensitive to several assumptions that the company has yet to disclose in detail. Key moving pieces include revenue generated per GW of deployed capacity, the ultimate mix between leased and self-built infrastructure across the planned 1GW rollout, potential GPU carve-out arrangements in Phase 2 and their impact on economics and margins, and, most importantly, the scale of Naver's total CapEx commitment under this evolving business model. Changes in any of these assumptions could materially alter the project's returns and valuation implications. At this stage, the company has provided only limited guidance, and we believe a more robust assessment will be possible once the terms of the first major customer contract are disclosed.
Source: Bernstein estimate and analysis.

EXHIBIT 3: **Our model incorporates NeoCloud revenue contributions starting in 3Q27, when we expect the project to begin generating recognizable revenue for Naver.**



Source: Bernstein estimate and analysis.

EXHIBIT 4: **As we have previously highlighted, management emphasized that the first phase of the 200MW buildout is focused on validating the economic viability of the project.**

	Phase 1: 200MW lease	Phase 2: 200MW owned	Phase 3: 600MW hybrid
Capacity & ownership	200MW (Existing leased sites)	200MW (Owned, Sejong expansion)	600MW (lease + owned/greenfield mix)
Asset ownership	DC leased GPUs owned by SPV	Owned DC, GPUs owned by SPV, Naver owns OperatingCo SPV	Mix of leased, owned domestic, and owned foreign SPVs
Naver equity role	Roughly 1 B USD in SPV	Additional equity in Operating Co; domestic focus	Smaller per-project equity; PropCo (infra SPV) + OperatingCo (Naver 51%)
Funding mix	c.10B USD capex: 1 B NVIDIA, 9B project debt	Sovereign/policy loans + project bonds + equity	Project finance, local partners, policy support, export-oriented capital
Contract model	Single anchor customer, 200MW take-or-pay	Additional capacity can be allocated to the anchor client	Portfolio of sovereign AI, hyper-scalers, regulated enterprises
Balance sheet impact	Most debt ring-fenced; expense flows through P&L	Still ring-fenced, but more owned assets; policy lowers cost of capital	Portfolio of off-BS SPVs, with Naver consolidating mainly operating entities
Strategic role	Prove economics	Establish Naver as domestic sovereign AI operator	Build regional AI platform and export AI DC solutions

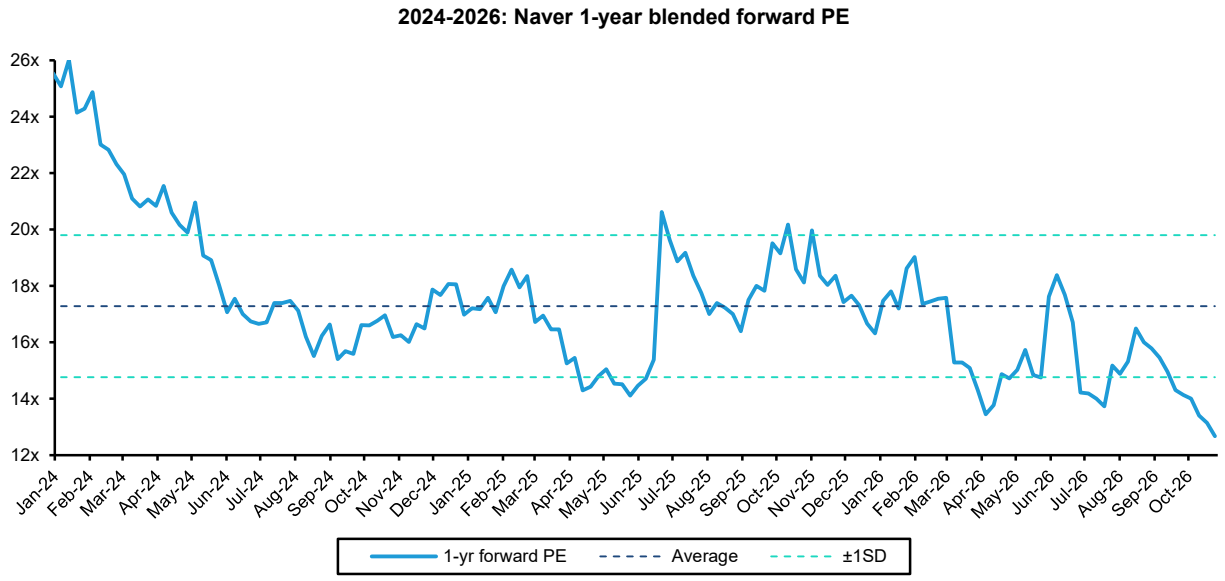
Disclaimer: The Phase 1-3 AI data center roadmap presented in this report is based on our analysis of publicly available information and discussions with industry participants. As Naver has not provided comprehensive public details on the project, certain assumptions have been made regarding the timing, ownership structure, financing approach, customer profile, and capacity expansion plans. As the project evolves, actual outcomes may differ from the scenarios outlined in this note. The Phase 1-3 framework should therefore be viewed as our analytical assessment rather than official company guidance.
Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein analysis.

EXHIBIT 5: **We've incorporated Naver Neocloud into our SOTP valuation. Given global AI infrastructure peers trade at 1-3.5x sales, we apply the low end of the valuation range until revenue visibility and the earnings trajectory become clearer.**

2027E	Base	Bull	Bear
Digital ad and commerce			
Revenue	10,274	**10,788**	**9,760**
Margin	25%	27%	23%
EBITA	2,532	2,875	2,210
Less: income tax @ 20%	-506	-575	-442
NOPAT	**2,026**	**2,300**	**1,768**
FY+1 PE multiple	12.0x	16.0x	8.0x
Core digital and and e-commerce equity value	**24,309**	**36,794**	**14,146**
Cloud			
Revenue	**1,833**	**1,924**	**1,741**
Margin	-30%	-25%	-35%
EBITA	(546)	(477)	(605)
FY+1 P/S multiple	2.0x	3.0x	1.0x
AI factory equity value	**3,666**	**5,773**	**1,741**
Webtoon			
Market cap (KRW)	1,695.0		
holding (%)	59.21%		
discount rate	50%		
Webtoon stake value	**669.1**	**669.1**	**669.1**
LY Corp			
Market cap (KRW)	30,214.7		
holding (%)	62.32%	A Holdings' stake in LY	
holding (%)	50.00%	Naver's stake in A Holdings	
discount rate	50%		
JY Corp stake value	**6,276.6**	**6,276.6**	**6,276.6**
Dunamu			
Corporate value	9,000		
holding (%)	17%		
Dunamu stake value	**1,530.0**	**1,530.0**	**1,530.0**
Group equity value	**36,450.4**	**51,043.4**	**24,363.3**
Group equity value per share	**243,815.36**	**324,604.72**	**154,935.33**

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimated and analysis.

EXHIBIT 6: **Naver has traded at an average of 18x one-year forward P/E over the past three years.**



Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 7: **We have valued Naver at a price target of KRW 240,000 based on a DCF valuation method, implying one year forward PER of 18x (Q3 2027-Q2 2028).**

DCF									
				Est.	Est.	Est.	Est.	Est.	Est.
KRW billion	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026**	**2027**	**2028**	**2029**	**2030**	**2035**
Revenue	**9,671**	**10,738**	**12,035**	**13,474**	**16,360**	**22,996**	**31,077**	**37,293**	**54,255**
Grow th YoY	17.6%	11.0%	12.1%	12.0%	21.4%	40.6%	35.1%	20.0%	5.0%
Operating profit	**1,489**	**1,979**	**2,208**	**2,008**	**2,247**	**2,665**	**3,142**	**3,729**	**5,425**
% of revenue	15.4%	18.4%	18.3%	14.9%	13.7%	11.6%	10.0%	10.0%	10.0%
Less: income tax	-298	-396	-442	-402	-449	-533	-628	-746	-1,085
Effective tax rate %	20.0%	20.0%	20.0%	20.0%	20.0%	20.0%	20.0%	20.0%	20.0%
NOPAT	**1,191**	**1,583**	**1,766**	**1,607**	**1,797**	**2,132**	**2,514**	**2,983**	**4,340**
Depreciation & amortization costs	174	172	183	252	311	432	548	658	957
Change in net w orking capital	-579	536	601	672	816	1,148	1,551	1,193	496
Capital expenditure	-692	-580	-1,317	-1,554	-1,800	-3,000	-3,000	-3,000	-600
Additions to intangibles	-1,964	-212	236	264	321	451	488	468	223
Free cash flow	**-1,870**	**1,499**	**1,469**	**1,242**	**1,446**	**1,162**	**2,101**	**2,303**	**5,417**
% of revenue	-19.3%	14.0%	12.2%	9.2%	8.8%	5.1%	6.8%	6.2%	10.0%
WACC	12.0%								
Terminal growth rate	2.0%								
Discount factor		-1.8	-0.8	0.2	1.2	2.2	3.2	4.2	9.2
Present value of FCF - per share		**0.0**	**0.0**	**1,399.0**	**8,042.0**	**5,772.8**	**9,316.4**	**9,116.9**	**12,169.7**
Sum of discounted cash flow s - per share		90,275							
NPV of terminal value - per share		124,131							
Enterprise value per share (KRW)		**214,406**							
Less: debt, preferred capital, minority interest		23,445							
Add: cash & equivalents		42,606							
Add: value of listed equity investments									
Implied 12-month forward price (KRW)		**240,000.0**							

(DCF assumptions: WACC=12%, Terminal growth rate: 2%; Risk-Free Rate of Return (Rf) = 3.6%, Market Risk Premium (Rm - Rf) = 17%, Beta = 0.5).
Source: Corporate reports, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 8: **Naver: Income Statement**

KRW billion	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E
Revenue	6,818	8,220	9,671	10,738	12,035	13,474	16,360	22,996	31,077
Operating, general and administrative	-5,492	-6,915	-8,182	-8,758	-9,827	-11,466	-14,113	-20,331	-27,935
Operating profit	**1,325**	**1,305**	**1,489**	**1,979**	**2,208**	**2,008**	**2,247**	**2,665**	**3,142**
Profit before tax	2,126	1,084	1,481	2,322	2,420	2,442	2,475	2,720	3,112
Income tax expense	-649	-411	-496	-390	-601	-500	-495	-544	-622
Net Income	**1,478**	**673**	**985**	**1,932**	**1,819**	**1,943**	**1,980**	**2,176**	**2,489**
Net profit attributable to SHs	1,490	760	1,012	1,923	1,953	1,920	1,957	2,153	2,466
EPS	**10,004**	**5,075**	**6,414**	**12,758**	**13,065**	**12,209**	**12,443**	**13,691**	**15,679**

Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 9: **Naver: Balance Sheet**

KRW billion	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E
Cash & cash equivalents	3,455	3,941	4,385	7,055	8,321	10,227	12,893	15,918	20,761
Accounts receivable	1,455	1,540	1,724	1,655	1,690	2,190	2,857	3,981	5,192
Other current assets	618	959	919	664	918	975	1,272	1,773	2,313
Total current assets	**5,528**	**6,440**	**7,028**	**9,375**	**10,929**	**13,392**	**17,022**	**21,672**	**28,267**
Investment assets	24,612	22,337	21,262	20,918	21,369	22,849	22,849	22,849	22,849
Tangible assets	2,111	2,458	2,742	2,910	3,608	4,700	6,056	8,072	10,813
Right of use assets	290	739	692	318	922	1,032	1,032	1,032	1,032
Other non-current assets	1,150	1,926	4,015	4,648	4,229	6,020	7,881	10,427	13,860
Total assets	**33,691**	**33,899**	**35,738**	**38,168**	**41,057**	**47,992**	**54,839**	**64,051**	**76,821**
Accounts payable	628	893	1,308	997	978	1,251	1,632	2,274	2,966
Advance received	374	416	498	568	787	774	1,010	1,408	1,836
Income tax payable	515	353	321	364	371	273	357	497	648
Short-term borrowings	0	0	250	0	1,597	319	362	423	505
Other current liabilities	2,406	3,819	3,929	4,163	4,255	5,195	5,195	5,195	5,195
Total Current Liabilities	**3,923**	**5,481**	**6,306**	**6,092**	**7,988**	**7,813**	**8,556**	**9,797**	**11,150**
Long-term debt	1,637	1,705	1,656	2,007	382	1,811	2,053	2,402	2,866
Long-term operating lease obligations	206	589	519	388	955	1,016	1,016	1,016	1,016
Other non-current liabilities	3,898	2,674	3,020	2,680	2,774	3,278	3,278	3,278	3,278
Total liabilities	**9,664**	**10,449**	**11,500**	**11,167**	**12,099**	**13,918**	**14,903**	**16,494**	**18,311**
Shareholders' equity	**24,027**	**23,450**	**24,238**	**27,001**	**28,958**	**34,074**	**39,936**	**47,557**	**58,510**
Total liabilities & shareholders' equi	**33,691**	**33,899**	**35,738**	**38,168**	**41,057**	**47,992**	**54,839**	**64,051**	**76,821**

Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 10: **Naver: Cash Flow Statement**

KRW billion	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E
Net (loss) income	**1,478**	**673**	**985**	**1,932**	**1,819**	**1,943**	**1,980**	**2,176**	**2,489**
Depreciation & amortization	127	157	174	172	183	252	311	432	548
Changes in working capital	265	298	-4	283	-129	-62	-106	-166	-143
Other	-182	-64	116	-100	728	0	0	0	0
Cash flow from operations	**1,688**	**1,065**	**1,271**	**2,286**	**2,600**	**2,133**	**2,185**	**2,442**	**2,894**
Capex	-781	-756	-692	-580	-1,337	-1,454	-1,800	-3,000	-3,000
Other	180	-302	447	-472	547	547	547	547	547
Cash flow from investments	**-600**	**-1,058**	**-246**	**-1,053**	**-791**	**-907**	**-1,253**	**-2,453**	**-2,453**
Cash flow from financing	**10,872**	**-497**	**-183**	**-1,133**	**-559**	**-2**	**99**	**132**	**164**
Net effect of exchange rate changes	-88	45	-90	140	-39	-518	-518	-518	0
Net change in cash	**11,872**	**-445**	**752**	**240**	**1,211**	**706**	**513**	**-397**	**605**
Beginning cash	3,846	2,781	2,336	3,088	3,328	4,539	5,245	5,758	5,361
Ending cash	**15,718**	**2,336**	**3,088**	**3,328**	**4,539**	**5,245**	**5,758**	**5,361**	**5,965**

Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			23 Oct 2026		TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.							
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
035420.KS (Naver)	O	KRW	173,600	**240,000**	(38.7)%	KRW	13,065	**12,209**	**12,443**	13.3	14.2	14.0
OLD				330,000				13,258	15,714			
ASIAX			1,786.55									

PRICE TARGET CHANGE / ESTIMATE CHANGE IN BOLD

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY

Naver Corporation

We have valued Naver at a price target of KRW 240,000 based on a DCF valuation method, implying one year forward PER of 18x (Q3 2027-Q2 2028). (DCF assumptions: WACC=12%, Terminal growth rate: 2%; Risk-Free Rate of Return (Rf) = 3.6%, Market Risk Premium (Rm - Rf) = 17%, Beta = 0.7).

RISKS

Naver Corporation

Downside risk: faster-than-expected declines in user engagement and monetization in the core search business; regulatory disapproval of the proposed Dunamu share swap; and weaker-than-expected NeoCloud economics.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

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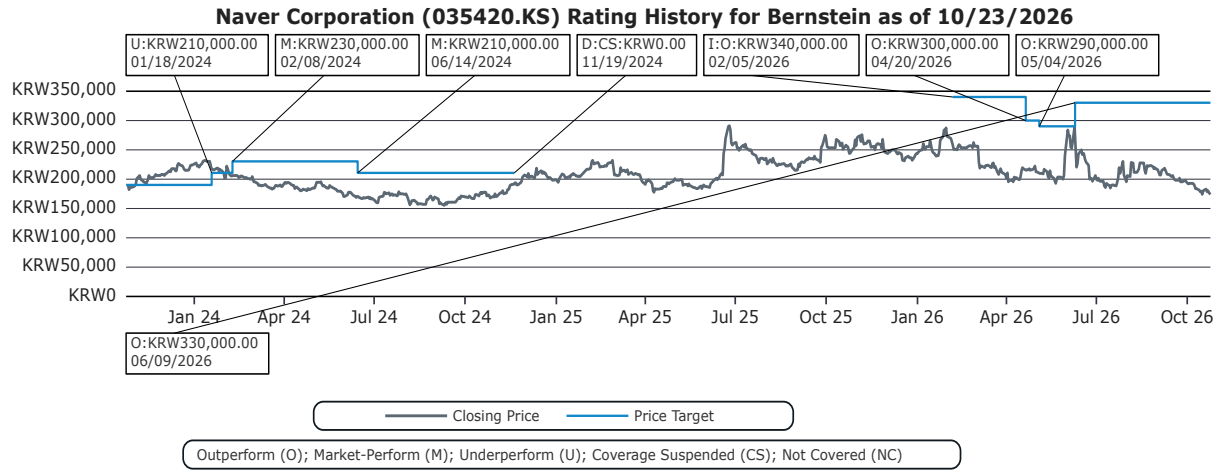
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